

Lessons Learned and Future Scope

Project Documentation | Import Data Using Transform Maps

1. Project Outcome

The project delivered a working, tested and documented import process in ServiceNow that loads file data accurately, prevents duplicates, handles invalid rows and logs every run.

2. Objectives vs Outcome

Objective	Outcome
Load CSV/Excel data accurately	Achieved: values matched source in tests
Prevent duplicates	Achieved: coalesce on email
Convert and validate values	Achieved: onBefore and field map scripts
Log every run	Achieved: Transform History and logs
Reusable process	Achieved: same map reused for later files

3. Lessons Learned

Area	Lesson
Data quality	Most problems came from the source file; validation in scripts is essential
Coalesce	A clean, stable key matters more than anything else for avoiding duplicates
Reference fields	Load reference data first and set the reference value field name
Testing	Repeat loads and invalid files uncover more defects than the happy path
Planning	Early design of mapping saved time during development
Documentation	A mapping sheet and file template reduce errors for data owners

4. Challenges and How They Were Handled

Challenge	Resolution
Duplicate users from email case differences	Trim and lower-case email before matching
Status values with spaces	Trim in the field map script
Manager reference not matching	Reference value field name set to email
Header row misread	Corrected data source settings

5. Limitations

- Only file-based imports (CSV/Excel) were covered.
- Tested on a PDI with small sample data.
- No automated scheduling in this version.

6. Future Scope

- Scheduled imports from a file location or MID server.
- Web service import sets (REST/SOAP) for system-to-system loads.
- Import into other tables: CMDB, incidents, catalog data.
- Dashboard for import statistics and errors.
- Notifications when imports finish or fail.

7. Glossary

Term	Meaning
Data Source	Record defining where and how to read incoming data
Import Set	Staging table holding raw imported rows
Transform Map	Rules mapping staging fields to target fields
Field Map	Link between one source and one target field
Coalesce	Field used to match and update existing records
Transform History	Log of each transform run and its counts
Update Set	Package of configuration changes moved between instances
PDI	Personal Developer Instance of ServiceNow

8. References

- ServiceNow Product Documentation: Import sets and Transform maps (docs.servicenow.com).
- ServiceNow Developer Site: developer.servicenow.com.
- ServiceNow Community articles on import sets and coalesce.